

Prior Authorization Request - Outpatient Procedure

Health Plan

Humana Medicare Advantage. Plan ID: H5216-014-000. Request type: standard pre-service review.
Date of request: 2026-10-06

Member Information

Member: Margaret Collins DOB: 1947-05-19 (age 79) Member ID: MBR-45001
Address: 118 Birch Street, Dayton, OH 45409
Phone: (937) 555-0105 Sex: F
Primary insurance: Humana Medicare Advantage (primary). Secondary: none on file.

Requesting Provider

Dr. Kevin Shah, MD -- Interventional Radiology
NPI: 1175038264
Practice: Westfield Spine Intervention Center
Phone: (937) 555-0140 Fax: (937) 555-0141

Requested Service

Requested service: Percutaneous vertebral augmentation (kyphoplasty), lumbar, one level
CPT 22514 ICD-10: M80.08XA (Age-related osteoporosis with current pathological fracture, vertebra, initial encounter)
Planned admit date: 2026-10-22
Level of care requested: OUTPATIENT
Place of service: Hospital outpatient department.

Submission Contact

Submitted through the provider portal by Sheila Brandt, Authorization Coordinator.
Callback: (937) 555-0140. Supporting clinical documentation attached (5 pages including this request).

Interventional Radiology Consultation

Date: 2026-09-28. Patient: Margaret Collins, age 79, female.

History

Sudden onset of severe low back pain on 2026-08-30 while lifting a laundry basket, 4 weeks and 5 days ago. Pain is worse with standing and turning in bed, 7/10 at rest on most days and 9/10 with movement. She is not hospitalized. The pain has been getting worse over the last 2 weeks despite treatment.

Non-surgical management so far (4 weeks)

Acetaminophen and tramadol 50 mg every 6 hours, a thoracolumbar brace worn since 2026-09-02, and 8 physical therapy visits for gentle mobility. Pain scale (NRS) is still 7 at rest and 9 with activity. Function: bed-to-chair transfers need help; Roland-Morris score 19 of 24.

Examination

Point tenderness over L1. Neurologic exam normal: strength 5/5, reflexes normal, no sensory loss, no bowel or bladder symptoms.

Plan

Percutaneous kyphoplasty at L1.

MRI Report - Lumbar and Thoracolumbar Spine

Date: 2026-09-22. Study: MRI of the thoracolumbar spine without contrast. Radiologist: Dr. Peter Wong, MD.

Findings: Acute compression fracture of L1 with marked bone marrow edema on STIR sequences. Vertebral body height loss about 38% anteriorly, with mild focal kyphosis of 14 degrees. No retropulsion, no canal compromise, no neural impingement. No epidural abscess. Multilevel osteopenia. No suspicious lesion; the appearance is osteoporotic.

Impression: Acute osteoporotic compression fracture of L1.

Bone Density and Labs

DEXA 2026-09-10: lumbar spine T-score -3.1. Diagnosis: osteoporosis.

Labs 2026-09-26: INR 1.0, platelets 245, WBC 6.8, ESR 14, CRP 4 mg/L. Calcium 9.4. No evidence of infection. Not on anticoagulants. No allergy to bone cement or contrast. Not pregnant (age 79).

Pre-procedure Clearance

Date: 2026-10-02. Physician: Dr. Rita Alvarez, MD.

Cleared for the procedure with conscious sedation, ASA class 3. No spinal instability on flexion-extension films. No myelopathy. Not hospitalized, living at home with her daughter.